

`stopAfter` replaces the magenta area with a recursive image once, makes one recursive call, reaches the base case, and immediately returns. Passing 2 for `stopAfter` causes two recursive calls, and so on.

This parameter prevents the function from recursing until it causes a stack overflow in cases when the magenta area is particularly large. It also lets us pass a smaller argument than 10 to limit the number of recursive images placed in the base image. For example, the four images in [Figure 14-2](#) were created by passing 0, 1, 2, and 3 for the `stopAfter` parameter.

Next, we check the color mode of the base image. This can be either `RGB` for an image with red-green-blue pixels or `RGBA` for an image that has an alpha channel for its pixels. The *alpha value* tells a pixel's level of transparency. Here's the code:

Python

```
# The magenta color has max red/blue/alpha, zero green:
if baseImage.mode == 'RGBA':
    magentaColor = (255, 0, 255, 255)
elif baseImage.mode == 'RGB':
    magentaColor = (255, 0, 255)
```

The Droste Maker needs to know the color mode so that it can find magenta pixels. The values for each channel range from 0 to 255, and magenta pixels have a maximum amount of red and blue but no green. Further, if an alpha channel exists, it would be set to 255 for a completely opaque color and 0 for a completely transparent one. The `magentaColor` variable is set to the correct tuple value for a magenta pixel depending on the image's color mode given in `baseImage.mode`.